

CLOSING TIME!

Once you've made it through the home inspection, loan process, appraisal, and all your due diligence—you're about to buy a house!

About a week before closing, you should go ask your bank about their procedures for wiring funds. Every bank is different, and you want to give yours enough time to prepare and send the wire. Lack of preparation is not a good excuse for missing a contractual deadline.

Your lender will verify your employment at least once more before closing, so don't quit your job just yet. (Seriously, if you're looking for a new job, do not change employers before closing.)

Your lender may also run your credit again, to which we again say: *no financial monkey business*. No new car, no furniture, no engagement ring that you put on a credit card. Every single lender in America has a truckload of stories about that marginal borrower who did something silly right before closing and could no longer qualify for a loan. Every single lender. If you are thinking about buying anything other than gas or groceries during the time between contract signing and closing, talk to your lender first. (And yes, we realize this is now the third time we've said this. We hope it's starting to sink in just how important it is to not engage in financial monkey business before closing.)

At least three days before closing, you will receive your closing statement, which accounts for everything you'll be paying, what the seller is paying, and how much money you will need to bring to the closing. Review these dollar amounts and prepare any extra money that you need to bring to the table. Call up the lender if anything doesn't make sense—but nothing should be a surprise at this point.

Remember when you dropped off your earnest-money check at the title company and picked up a copy of the wire transfer information? This is when you use that paper. Physically go into your bank and tell them you need to wire funds for a real estate closing. (Make sure the funds are in your account and available for use, or you're in Trouble with a capital T!) Hand the wire transfer instructions to the bank, and they will take over. Ask when the wire will be initiated and when the title company should receive it, then reach out to the title company to make sure it did arrive.